

dance festival

Step Up the Spirit

DELHI Dance is a manifestation of the inner joy of being alive. It elevates the body to a spiritual experience, said kathak maestro Birju Maharaj. Artistes in the Capital have organised two festivals to celebrate International Dance Day, which falls on April 29—the birthday of French dancer Jean Georges Noverre (1727-1810), considered the father of modern ballet. Noverre infused new thought and fresh perspective into dance presentation by emphasising the need to integrate choreography, narrative, music and set design.

To celebrate the occasion, Natya Vriksha has organised a two-day festival on April 26-27 at the India International Centre. On the first day, there will be an interface with Avinash Pasricha, master lensman of Indian dance, followed by a bharatanatyam performance by Geeta Chandran.

On the second day, photographer Ram Dhamija will display pictures of two dance legends—Bala Saraswathy and Shambhu Maharaj—and speak on his conversations with them. This will be followed by a kathak recital by Saswati Sen.

The Kri Foundation, too, has a three-day festival from April 27-29 at the Habitat Centre. The festival, which features international dance video films, will see three of India's most celebrated

dancers and forms—Sonal Mansingh (odissi), Prathibha Prahlad (bharatanatyam), and Jayant Kastuar (kathak)—come

together. These masters will perform to live accompaniment.

SPICMACAY has lined up dance performances at various schools on April 29. The participating dancers are Rama Vaidyanathan (bharatanatyam), Kiran Sehgal (odissi), Uma Sharma, Shovana Narayan and Rajendra Gangani (kathak). Be there to see the legends in full form.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit



CELEB CELEBRATION: Gangani (above); Prahlad



EPA

photography exhibition

A Kingdom Captured

DELHI The black-and-white images are stark, whether they are of a young woman on her way to a disco in modern-day Thimpu, Bhutan; an old man with his hands folded; or a village woman, her fingers entangled in her hair, a far-away look in her eyes. Every photograph weaves its own story, which photo-journalist Serena Chopra tries to tell through her lens. It took the 54-year-old five years of hiking into the interiors of Bhutan to document a country that holds on to its culture while making its transition to modernity. The exhibition of portraits, titled 'Bhutan: A Certain Modernity', she says, is not an ethnographic study, but is a way of transporting the viewer to a different place. The exhibition travelled to New York and then to Thimpu. It is now being shown at the Photolab Gallery in Delhi. On till May 10. by Chitra Subramanyam

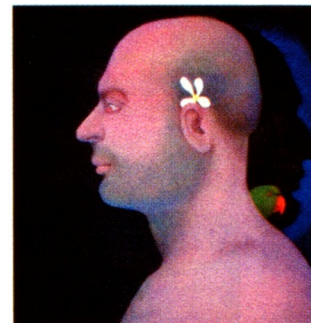
A DIFFERENT PLACE: A black-and-white portrait



art exhibition

Narrative Delight

DELHI From being a humble cinema and circus hoarding painter in Punjab, Ali Kazim went to the National College of Arts in Lahore and developed a painting technique referencing the miniature but incorporating his own innovations. Kazim introduces narrative fragments interspersed by fantasy. The exhibition re-



Kazim's work veals his interest in simplifying organic shapes and playing with silhouettes. At Gallery Espace, till May 7.